Neither example is a must-have policy. Indeed, the second one might be too tight for the average company, but for Messflix, both do fit.

Computational data governance is necessary from the very beginning of the data mesh to utilize the mesh character itself. Without governance, it is not possible to consume or combine nodes of the data mesh in a self-serve manner. If this is not possible, human intervention is needed, which doesn't scale and thus stops the data mesh at its beginning.

6.5.1 Making policies computational

Making a policy *computational* means turning it into an algorithm.

DEFINITION We can loosely define an *algorithm* as a set of steps that can be automatically followed, possibly having an input and an output.

Turning a policy into an algorithm sounds like something a developer would do. But that's not recommended at all. Instead, the governance team should do it because turning a policy into an algorithm will always put a particular interpretation into the words, which means the policy will get modified or clarified by this process.

At the same time, the governance team will also have to think about how deep it wants to go by enforcing a particular policy. Let's look at two examples to understand this.

EXAMPLE 1: BUSINESS DOMAIN INFORMATION

The policy for this example is as follows:

- All data should contain metadata that identifies its business domain.

From our MVP, the governance team can turn this policy into an algorithm pretty easily, as shown here

- Input—Metadata for a domain data product from the central registry.
- Retrieve the business unit key in the metadata.